



Human body: skeleton

Skull
protects
your brain.

Your skeleton has 208 bones! It gives you your human shape and protects your vital organs. Without bones and muscles, you couldn't move.

Bones

Bones are made of a hard, strong material called calcium.

We get calcium from milk.

Did you know?

Every time you smile you use 17 muscles. But every time you frown you use 43.



Bone joints

Ball-and-socket joint at shoulder

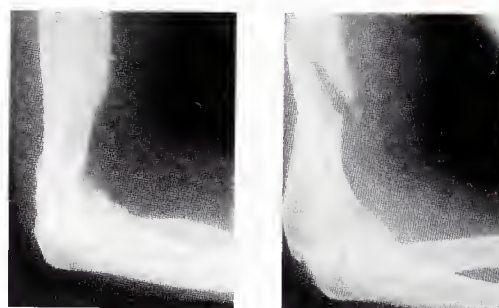
Hinge joint

Joints are places where bones meet. They allow your body to bend.

False hip joint

False knee joint

False plastic joints are used to replace real joints if they wear out.



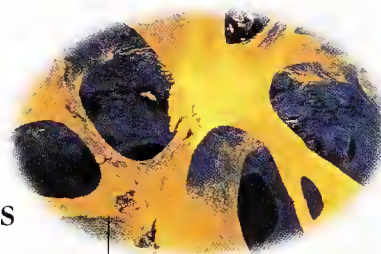
Broken bone

X-ray pictures

If a bone breaks, a doctor may wrap it in a plaster cast. This helps the bone grow together.

Long bones

Long bones are strong but light because they have air holes inside.



Inside of a bone, magnified thousands of times

Muscles

You have about 600 muscles. They work with your bones to help you move, skip, and jump.

Thigh muscle pulls on the bone, making your leg move.

How muscles work

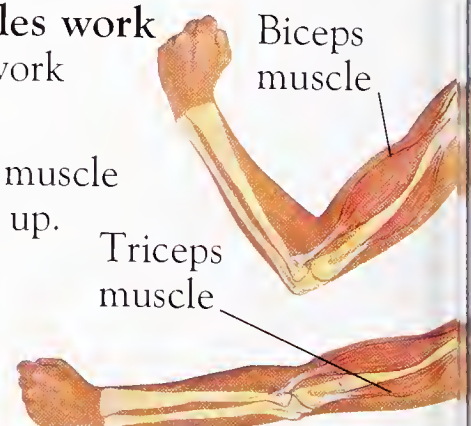
All muscles work in pairs.

1 The biceps muscle pulls the arm up.

2 The triceps muscle pulls the arm down.

Biceps muscle

Triceps muscle



Shinbone

Your foot has 26 bones.

Ankle joint

Kneecap

Thigh-bones are the longest bones.

Your hand has 27 bones.

Elbow joint

Rib cage protects your heart and lungs.

Shoulder blade

Spine

Hip joint

